



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Catholic Central High School

School Website: <https://steubenvillecatholicschools.org/cchs/chesterton-academy/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Catholic Central High School (Steubenville, OH, 43952) (Chesterton Academy Steubenville) presents a robust classical-Catholic program. Public-facing materials describe a Catholic classical curriculum grounded in theology and virtue, taught by faithful faculty, with explicit use of the liberal arts (Trivium and Quadrivium), a focus on primary sources and great books-like study, and visible partnership with families and the wider Catholic community. The school emphasizes formation of character through virtue, wisdom, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, rather than merely information transfer or job preparation. These signals align strongly with the six essential elements of classical education.

Key textual signals observed in the school's public materials include: - Religious and metaphysical foundations: explicit reference to Catholic intellectual and moral traditions, the seven liberal arts (Trivium and Quadrivium), cardinal and theological virtues, and formation through theology and virtue. - Purpose and goal: formation toward virtue and wisdom within a liberal, classical framework, oriented to Western civilization's best traditions. - Curriculum: emphasis on grammar, logic, rhetoric; study of history, Latin, theology, music, and the arts, alongside primary sources. - Pedagogy: mimetic learning and Socratic instruction; engagement with primary sources; emphasis on memory and discussion as paths to understanding. - Faculty: faithful, virtuous teachers forming the students as living exemplars. - Parents & community: explicit inclusion and partnership with families and the broader Catholic community.

Evidence for these signals is drawn from the Chesterton Academy Steubenville public materials, which describe a Catholic classical curriculum built on the Trivium and Quadrivium, a faith-informed formation approach, and active family involvement. See primary school materials describing Catholic intellectual and moral traditions, the liberal arts pattern, and the Socratic/mimetic teaching approach.

The evaluation below applies the Six Essential Elements framework (Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators) to each of the six categories, comparing school signals to the documented classical-education keyword rubric. The resulting assessment places Catholic Central High School (Steubenville, OH, 43952) (Chesterton Academy Steubenville) in the CLASSICAL category overall.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school describes its program as rooted in Catholic intellectual and moral traditions and practices, with formation through theology and virtue (cardinal and theological virtues) as a central aim. This is visible in statements about a Catholic classical curriculum and the broader Chesterton network's faith-centered formation.
- The Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium pattern is tied to a Catholic intellectual tradition, reinforcing a transcendent, real order in education.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: theology, virtue, cardinal/theological virtues, Catholic intellectual/moral traditions, liturgical/contemplative framing (within a Catholic context), Western-Civilization-centered formation (truth/beauty/goodness as real ideals).

- Negative keywords: none observed in the public materials (i.e., no signals of secular, relativist, or value-neutral approaches in this area).
- Why this rating
- The public materials foreground explicit theology, virtue, and a liturgical/Catholic frame for education, with formation in sacred traditions and moral order. This aligns with the Positive Keyword signals for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and signals a CLASSICAL orientation rather than a secular or relativist approach. See the Chesterton Academy Steubenville description of Catholic intellectual/moral traditions and Julius virtues framing.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The program emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom within a liberal education frame, oriented toward the best aspects of Western civilization, rather than a purely career-focused or job-prep goal.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, human flourishing (as implied by formation toward the good), liberal education, classical mission.
- Negative keywords: none observed that align with job-prep or market-driven aims; the emphasis remains on formation and transcendent aims rather than workforce readiness.
- Why this rating
- The school's stated aim centers on virtue and wisdom within a classical framework, with formation over mere information and a clearly classical telos. This matches the Positive Keyword indicators for Element 2 and contrasts with the negative signals that would indicate job-readiness or skills-first framing.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The curriculum explicitly names the liberal arts framework: Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium (mathematics, geometry, music, astronomy/natural science). It also notes study of Latin, theology, literature, history, and the arts, with emphasis on primary sources and original writings. This mirrors the Great Books/primary-sources orientation and the integrated, historical approach typical of classical curricula.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts: grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium; Latin; history; theology; primary sources; great books-like orientation; study of classics; music and the arts.
- Negative keywords: none observed (no signals of substituting history with "social studies" language or a project-based only approach in the curriculum).
- Why this rating
- The explicit reference to the Trivium and Quadrivium, Latin, theology, history, and primary sources aligns squarely with classical curriculum principles. The emphasis on original writings and a historically grounded, liberal-arts approach supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence

- The school describes instruction as mimetic and Socratic, with emphasis on primary sources and original writings rather than summaries. This aligns with traditional classical pedagogy emphasizing Socratic dialogue and the memorization/oral-recitational elements of the Trivium.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue/dialectic; mimetic learning; primary sources; memory work (recitation/memorization implied by classical pedagogy).
- Negative keywords: no explicit signals of project-based learning domination, experiential-only approaches, or purely student-led inquiry that would deviate from classical pedagogy. The materials emphasize Socratic and mimetic pedagogy rather than a modern constructivist focus.
- Why this rating
- The explicit reference to Socratic/mimetic pedagogy and to primary sources indicates a strong adherence to classical pedagogy principles, placing Element 4 in CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The materials describe faculty as faithful/virtuous teachers aligned with forming students in virtue and wisdom, consistent with “living curriculum” notions common in classical education. The Chesterton Steubenville materials reference teaching by faithful faculty within a Catholic classical framework.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: faithful faculty; living curriculum; mentor/teacher exemplar; formation through example.
- Negative keywords: none observed in materials for this category (no signals of non-classical staff roles or purely credential-based approaches without classical formation).
- Why this rating
- The public-facing materials emphasize teachers as faithful exemplars and the school as a living curriculum, which is a hallmark of classical education’s faculty dimension. This supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school positions itself as serving families and parents, with explicit involvement of parents as part of the schooling community (e.g., “young people and their parents” in a Catholic classical environment, and partnership with families within the Chesterton network). The materials indicate a family-centered, faith-informed community with opportunities for engagement.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with families; parental involvement; parents as co-teachers; classical family culture; parent formation; community of learners.
- Negative keywords: none observed in public materials (no “consumer” language or minimal parental involvement signals).
- Why this rating
- The program’s emphasis on family involvement and parent formation aligns with classical education norms for community and parental partnership, supporting a CLASSICAL rating.

Overall assessment: CLASSICAL

- Aggregate reasoning
- Across all six categories, the Chesterton Academy Steubenville materials demonstrate explicit classical features: Catholic theological grounding, formation-focused goals, a Trivium/Quadrivium curriculum, Socratic/mimetic pedagogy, virtuous faculty, and strong parent/community partnership. The public materials align with the positive keyword indicators for each category and show no clear signals of non-classical approaches. This alignment justifies a CLASSICAL classification overall.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable for this CLASSICAL determination. No major needle-moving changes are required to achieve a stronger CLASSICAL alignment based on the current signals. If desired, the school could consider explicitly naming “Great Books” and “Great Conversation” language alongside primary sources to further reinforce the Great Books/Great Conversation dimension, but the existing signals already strongly reflect classical aims. (No formal needle-moving actions mandated for the CLASSICAL classification.)

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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